

Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-04

Linux

Zig 0.17 released

Source: *LWN.net*

Version 0.17 of the Zig programming language has been released. This release features 5 months of work : changes from 206 different contributors , spread among 925 commits . Originally predicted to be shorter, this release cycle ended up [being] substantial, with the Build System reworked, including...

Seven stable kernels for Saturday

Source: *LWN.net*

Greg Kroah-Hartman has announced the release of the 7.2.9 , 6.18.55 , 6.12.112 , 6.6.158 , 6.1.189 , 5.15.222 , and 5.10.271 stable kernels. Each contains a large number of important fixes throughout the tree; users are advised to upgrade.

SystemD wants App Permission Tracking on Linux

Source: *SavvyNik*

Systemd is introducing a new app permission tracking component on Linux. Let's talk about whether this makes sense and what the new component will do for Linux flatpaks. Does systemd really need this and the drama it's already caused. My Linux Bundle is here: <https://savvynik.com> Think your Ready...

Linus Torvalds: "We're Going in the Wrong Direction"

Source: *SavvyNik*

Linus Torvalds Speaks on workflow and how AI affects the Linux kernel development and open source. We also hear from other projects and how they're being overwhelmed by AI reports and patches. There's a lot of changes happening to the Linux Kernel because of recent dev and tools like AI/LLMs. We'll...

Security

ShinyHunters Suspect Rey Reportedly Detained in Jordan, Helping FBI Identify Group Members

Source: *The Hacker News*

A suspected member of the ShinyHunters digital extortion group, who goes by the online alias "Rey," has been allegedly detained by authorities in Jordan, Reuters reported, citing three people familiar with the matter. Rey, whose real name is Saif al-Din Khader, is said to have been brought into cus...

China-Aligned TA419 Targets U.S. AI Policy Experts With Microsoft AitM Phishing

Source: The Hacker News

A new China-nexus cyber espionage group known as TA419 has been attributed to multiple credential phishing campaigns targeting artificial intelligence (AI) experts working for U.S. think tanks, universities, and legal sector organizations. The campaigns have impersonated prominent economists and AI...

MI5 Says China's MSS Funded Research Involving 100+ U.K.-Linked Academics

Source: The Hacker News

The U.K.'s domestic intelligence and security agency has warned that more than 100 academics have helped China boost its intelligence gathering efforts on behalf of Beijing's state security service. In a "Security Service Espionage Alert" issued on September 30, 2026, MI5 said the "primary purpose o...

Warlock Exploits SharePoint Flaws to Disable Security Tools and Deploy Ransomware

Source: The Hacker News

The suspected China-linked threat actor known as Warlock is still continuing to weaponize Microsoft SharePoint vulnerabilities, likely both old and new, in attacks targeting organizations in Portuguese- and Spanish-speaking countries. The activity, observed by the Symantec and Carbon Black Threat Hu...

The State of Cybersecurity in 2026: Key Segments, Insights, and Innovations

Source: The Hacker News

Featuring: Cybersecurity is being reshaped by the expansion of cloud infrastructure, AI, distributed systems, and increasingly complex digital environments. As organizations manage more identities, devices, data, and internet-facing infrastructure, security is shifting toward continuous visibility,...

General Tech

VGHF Digital Archive passes 5000 magazines. Here's what's next

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://gamehistory.org/5k-magazines/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49952029> Points: 20 # Comments: 2

In Ukraine, distributed renewables foil Russia's assaults

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://energytransition.org/2026/09/in-ukraine-distributed-renewables-foil-russias-assaults/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49951881> Points: 81 # Comments: 56

Emitting metadata early makes building/checking Rust up to twice as fast

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://github.com/PowderworksCode/headstart> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49951218> Points: 7 # Comments: 0

Why don't more developers “use the platform”?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://nolanlawson.com/2026/10/03/why-dont-more-developers-use-the-platform/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49950554> Points: 150 # Comments: 119

Religious scholars met with Anthropic

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

<https://archive.is/y8FW0> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49950052> Points: 81 # Comments: 177

We're working on a new RuneScape MMO

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://play.runescape.com/4> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49949588> Points: 72 # Comments: 30

Tell HN: Bob Cringely has died

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

I heard from a friend of the family that Bob passed away in his sleep early Saturday. Very sad news. Bob, who's real name was Mark Stevens, was an early employee of Apple and was best known for his PBS documentaries, especially "Triumph of the Nerds". He will be missed. Comments URL: <https://news.yc...>

We're going to need default hard budget caps on pretty much everything

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/3/default-hard-budget-caps/>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49949235> Points: 446 #
Comments: 219

Reasons I didn't become an EMT, ranked

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://ben.stolovitz.com/posts/reasons-not-emt-ranked/> Comments
URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49947631> Points: 155 # Comments:
75

Surely you have ultra-wideband radios on your bins too?

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://sjg.io/writing/binrange-have-you-actually-put-the-bins-out/>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49947472> Points: 78 #
Comments: 38

We want you to build the next Git platform on Cloudflare

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/next-git-platform-on-cloudflare/> Comments
URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49947051> Points: 136 # Comments:
117

The work by Valve's Timur Kristóf on improving old AMD GPUs on Linux

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.phoronix.com/news/XDC-2026-Valve-Timur-AMDGPU>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946895> Points: 299 #
Comments: 46

How to hack time, with C2PA

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.da.vidbuchanan.co.uk/blog/hacking-time.html> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946707> Points: 40 # Comments: 4

What Meta got right with Muse

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://metedata.substack.com/p/what-meta-got-right-with-muse>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946526> Points: 51 # Comments: 69

Hole Punch: Sling your spaceship around gravitational fields

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://notoriousbfg.com/hole-punch/> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946393> Points: 299 # Comments: 67

Treachery in the Rodin Museum 3D scan verdict

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://cosmowenman.substack.com/p/rodin-museum-3d-scan-verdict>
Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946355> Points: 209 # Comments: 91

LeCun has "zero concerns" about AI wiping out humanity, recent "rogue" incidents

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

<https://archive.ph/TyDPf> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49946228> Points: 141 # Comments: 191

Agents don't need memory, they need documentation

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://liao.gg/blog/agents-dont-need-memory> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49945933> Points: 186 # Comments: 105

City building games have a Soul Problem pt.2

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

Article URL: <https://www.radical-elements.com/minor-epiphanies/city-building-games-have-a-soul-problem-pt2> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49945323> Points: 137 # Comments: 134

FTL: A new operating system for clouds

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

<https://github.com/nuta/ftl> Comments URL: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=49944912> Points: 175 # Comments: 67